

NMIMS Global Access
School for Continuing Education (NGA-SCE)
Course: Business Communication
Internal Assignment Applicable for June 2022 Examination

Ans 1. Introduction: - Adapting the message to the audience involves identifying the interests and benefits of a message to the audience. The content of the message must be presented in an interesting way and it must include topics which can create interest and also benefit the audience in some or the other way. If the audience cannot relate themselves with the topic, they might not feel interested in the speech and they might also leave the place where the message is been delivered.

Concepts and Application: - When a message is delivered to the audience, it must be explained in simple terms keeping in mind about the expectations of the audience and the effectiveness in explaining it to them. If the speaker uses some technical terms or some terms which the audience might not be familiar with, then the audience might quickly lose interest in the message being delivered. There are certain rules and etiquettes to follow before delivering a message to the audience. Those are explained as follows: -

⇒ **Using the 'You' Attitude:** - In a professional message the 'you' attitude is developed more than the 'we' or 'me' attitude. 'You' attitude means looking at a topic from the reader's point of view. This helps in establishing a better and respectful relationship with the reader or listener by addressing them writing in passive voice and using the form of second person. More emphasise is given from the reader's point of view rather from the writer's point of view. Below are few of the examples of 'We' and 'You' attitude: -

1. **I or We attitude:** - We can provide our new discount policy which might be attractive to you.

You attitude: - You can avail our newly introduced discounted policy.

2. **I or We attitude:** - I am glad that you chose our firm.

You attitude: - Thank you for giving us the opportunity to serve you.

The main objective of You attitude is not to hurt the sentiments of the audience and conveying the message using **Euphemisms**. Euphemisms are words or phrases that are used to neutralise any harsh or blunt facts which are used to convey any message to the audience. One example of such phrase used in referring certain people beyond a certain age as "senior citizen" rather than referring them as "old people". The term 'senior' pays respect as it depicts more experience in every field, which 'old' does not.

- ⇒ **Maintaining standards of etiquette:** - Maintaining certain standards of etiquettes while communicating to the audience generally demonstrates the honour which is paid to the audience. There are certain factors which can set the standard of business communication such as determining the correct medium of communication such as sending emails, talking over telephone calls, text messaging etc., the tone being used to convey the message, the respect given to the seniors, using formal and generous words to report the issues and also providing a better environment to work. These standards are set basically to minimise the negative effects which often damages the reputation of the work culture of the company. Written communication in the medium of digitally or paper communication requires more attention than the verbal communication. Because if the message is delivered verbally then words can be neutralised by using soft words and also through kind facial expressions. But when the communication is done in a written form then clear expression of words must be used. For example: - In place of saying “The efforts given by you in previous week has affected in our production levels”, we can say “Let’s ascertain the challenges you have faced which has affected your productivity”.
- ⇒ **Emphasizing the positive:** - In an organisation, a manager or an HR or any other higher officials often has to deliver some bad news to its employee. But delivering the bad news with some positivity often reduces the emotional burden off the employee. This is the reason why the words of communicating some bad news effects positively when it is delivered positively to the audience. For example: - Instead of saying “We have lost ₹ 1 Crore in advertisement”, we can say “The amount of ₹ 1 Crore has not given us the expected results so we need to analyse what else can be improved in the process”. This kind of positive sentences create a positive effect in the minds of the employee and helps in reducing the stress of the employees.
- ⇒ **Using Bias Free Language:** - While delivering a message the speaker must not use any biased words or phrases which might hurt the sentiments of the audience. Biased language might be related to gender bias, racial and ethnic bias, age bias, cultural bias, disability bias etc. When the speaker uses bias free language, it explains the perception of the speaker towards the audience of any culture. Moreover, it provides a fair and equal opportunity for any group of people or any individual people. The various forms of bias are explained as below: -
- **Gender Bias:** - The language used while conveying a message must not be gender biased or it must not define any individual group of gender. For example, instead of using ‘manpower’ we can use ‘workforce’ or ‘employees’. This defines the total working staff of an organisation regardless of being a male or a female employee.
 - **Racial and Ethnic Bias:** - The speaker must avoid using any words or phrases which might be racist or affects any groups ethnicity. No individuals or a group of people must be identified by their colour, caste or language. There must be a common medium of identification of a person.
 - **Age Bias:** - The age of any individual must not be mentioned until and unless it is necessary. Few terms like old, inexperienced, immature must not be used which describes one’s age group.

- **Disability Bias:** - One's physical, mental or any other disability should not be described or mentioned if it's not necessary in any official records.

Conclusion: - Framing the sentences with proper words and phrases is very important which helps in reducing the stress and misunderstanding among the audience or the employees. These set of certain standards must be maintained in every organisation to maintain decency among the workers of the organisation.

Ans 2. Introduction: - Often businesses or companies ask from their employees for a recommendation letter from their professors or any other renowned person who can describe the employee's talent, skills, ability and the reason they are fit for the job. Some people might not be comfortable in allowing their names to be written for recommendation, hence prior permission is required to be taken from that person. There should be proper mention of why the recommendation letter is required. If it is required for any job purpose or any other purpose it should be mentioned clearly. If the employee hasn't had any contact with the professor or the person from whom the recommendation letter is to be taken, then the employee must mention about some memories with the person or some achievements if there were any or any kind of association with the person must be mentioned.

Letter of Recommendation: - The letter of recommendation must contain the name and address of the addressee, name and address of the sender, the purpose of the letter with which the letter is sent to the addressee, some events to refresh the memory of the receiver, the deadline by which the sender is expecting a response of recommendation and the ending of the letter must be done with some warm and respectful greetings. Below is an example of how to write a letter of recommendation to the professor: -

11th May, 2022

11th Street Park,
Green Park Avenue
New Delhi- 110118

Professor Hari Srivastav
School of Excellence
University of Nalanda
Bihar- 582401

Dear Professor Hari,

I am Lisa from School of Excellence and I passed out in the year 2019. It is my greatest pleasure to inform you that I recently gave an interview for Masters in Management from BHU, Varanasi. They have requested a letter of recommendation from any of my professor and I suddenly remembered you. May I request you for a letter of recommendation?

As you may recall, I attended Finance class from you in the year 2018 semester during my bachelor's degree. You helped me build an intrinsic interest in this subject and scored good marks in this subject and later I developed much interest towards pursuing the Master's degree in management.

I have provided my résumé which includes all my experience in various fields during my bachelor's degree. I have made several projects in the field of Finance which helps me in further enhancing my skills. I have researched extensively in the field of Finance for the last 3 years. This also provides an extra edge over the other candidates for the job.

The professors from BHU, Varanasi has expected a reply against their request of letter of recommendation by 30th May, 2022. For your convenience, a preaddressed stamped envelope has been kept ready.

I would like to thank you for taking out your valuable time in writing this letter of recommendation. I will keep you posted about my further progress in my career. I appreciate your consideration in this matter.

Sincerely,

Lisa

Conclusion: - The letter of recommendation provides some extra information about the candidate, whether the candidate is fit for the job or not. When the candidate is recommended by any senior trusted person or by any professor, it provides an extra edge over the selection of the perfect candidate by the institute or any organisation. This also revives the good relation among the professor and the student.

Ans 3. A) Introduction: - When a customer faces discrepancy regarding his/her order, he/she must contact with the seller of the product. For instance, here Flipkart is the seller of the product, therefore the customer must contact the Flipkart customer care phone number or write in mail about the difficulties the customer has faced in receiving the amount to be credited after returning the product. These kinds of discrepancies might happen with anybody purchasing products online as because there are huge number of transactions being carried out in a single day.

Tone of claiming a letter: - When a customer is dissatisfied with the services being provided by an online shopping site or by any other type of company, the customer should write them in a polite way which will help in resolving their issue sooner. Even if the customer is angry or frustrated, he/she must maintain a professional tone while writing a mail. In the first paragraph, the issue must be claimed properly with a request to resolve the issue. In the body of the mail, specific details must be provided regarding the order with order number, date of order, date of return of the product, invoices, bank statements, sales receipt or any other relevant documents. The original copies of these documents must be kept with the customer and only the duplicate copies must be sent to the company. In the closing of the mail, a polite request can be done to resolve the issue as soon as possible. And if possible, an appropriate suggestion can be mentioned that the business relation between the customer and the company can be maintained only if the issue is resolved with a quicker process and the amount is credited to the customer.

The customer can express his/her expectations from the company about what needs to be done regarding his/her complaint. The customer can demand a full refund of the order which has been returned or he/she might also demand an exchange of the same product or any other product of the same amount of the previous order.

Conclusion: - These kinds of discrepancies might be committed by any online shopping sites as they handle a huge amount of data regarding customer orders. If the customer maintains some decency and registers their complaint, then the consent of the customer might be resolved sooner.

Ans 3. B) Introduction: - The opening paragraph of the mail must be short and calmly state the problem faced by the consumer. The body of the mail must provide specific details regarding the problem faced by the consumer such as bank statements, order details etc. And finally, the closing of the mail must be with a kind request of taking specific action and resolving the issue.

Complaint letter to Flipkart: - The proper format in which the letter must be written to Flipkart is shown below: -

To	www.flipkart.com
Cc	
Subject	Request for amount to be credited for returned product

Respected Customer Care Executive:

I recently returned a product 'Kitchen Aid Stand Mixer' which I bought from Flipkart but did not receive the amount which was to be credited to my account. Please look forward to this complaint and take some necessary steps.

I bought a Kitchen Aid Stand Mixer from Flipkart on 1st January 2022, which costed me ₹40,000. This purchase also promised me an offer of free delivery and 40-day money-back guarantee. I decided to return the product on 5th January as it did not stand up to my expectations. The order no. was F80334678-1024 for the product. I called the customer care once in every week and they promised that my amount would be credited to my account soon but it never happened till date. I have attached my bank statement and other credentials which would be helpful to you to refer to.

I hope this complaint will be given utmost importance and necessary action will be taken by your representative to resolve the issue and maintain a healthy business relationship between myself and the company.

Sincerely,

Jass Javvy
Proprietor

Conclusion: - Writing a mail in proper format and mild tone will surely help the consumer in resolving his/her issue. This will also keep a written record with both the consumer and the company about the complaint made by customer.

-----*****-----